

Meet Cute Quick Start

Meet Cute is an invite-only matchmaking service. There is no swiping. A real matchmaker picks one introduction at a time, both people say yes before anything happens, and a concierge handles booking the first date. There are also curated group dinners. People sign in with a one-time link sent to their email, so there is no password to remember. What someone sees depends on their role: members get the dating app, operators get the back office, which we call the studio.

For members

A new member applies with their email, clicks the link we send, and fills out a short application: name, date of birth, city, what they are looking for, and agreement to the terms. A matchmaker reviews it. Once approved, the member builds their profile with a headline, a short bio, a few photos, and a note on what they want and what they don't.

From then on the home screen shows a single introduction at a time, with a note from the matchmaker on why the two might fit. The member chooses to be introduced or to pass. When both people say yes, the concierge takes over: it suggests a venue and a few specific times, and once their picks line up it confirms the reservation and sends a calendar invite. Members can also RSVP to any dinners they are invited to, and they stay in control of their own safety and privacy. They can block or report anyone, export their data, or delete their account and everything in it.

For operators

Operators sign in the same way and land in the studio. The roster is the full member list, searchable and filterable, and the place where applicants are approved or declined. Opening a member shows their history, notes, and a quick way to suggest a match. The pipeline tracks every match from the first suggestion through to a relationship, and includes a manual override to pair any two members directly when the matchmaker knows better than the filters.

Events is where an operator creates a dinner and adds guests from the roster. Each guest is emailed automatically, and their replies are tracked on the event. Moderation handles photo approvals and any safety reports. The team page controls who has operator access.

The co-pilot is the studio's command line. Beyond answering questions about the roster, it carries out instructions directly. Tell it to match Maya and Alex, invite them to the next dinner in New York, create a dinner at a specific venue and time, book a date, or ask what needs attention, and it does the work. Those commands run for real.

Signing in and testing

Everyone signs in through a one-time email link. For test accounts whose inbox you do not control, generate a direct link from the command line:

```
npm run login-link -- jesswolflord@gmail.com
npm run login-link -- maya@meetcute.test
npm run login-link -- alex@meetcute.test
```

To set up a sample scenario, run the fixture:

```
npm run test:fixture
```

That creates two members, Maya Rosen and Alex Chen, with one introduction waiting between them. Open Maya's link and accept the introduction to Alex, then open Alex's link and accept Maya. The match becomes mutual, and from either member's matches you will see the concierge propose times. Pick slots on both sides to confirm. Open the operator link to watch that same match move through the studio pipeline.

To manage operators from the command line:

```
npm run ops -- list
npm run ops -- add name@email.com "Full Name" NYC
npm run ops -- remove name@email.com
```

Notes for production

Photo uploads use cloud storage when a storage token is set, and fall back to local disk otherwise. Error tracking turns on once a Sentry key is added. Database schema changes are applied with the db:deploy script, never during a build.